

GAME DESIGN

Queue-Based Puzzle Game

Project Overview :-

This project focuses on designing a low-stimulation, logic-based puzzle game where players arrange characters in a queue based on their individual needs or “excuses.” The core intention was to create a calm, non-competitive experience (no timer, no pressure) that helps users:

- Improve decision-making
- Reduce cognitive overload
- Engage in gentle problem-solving

The concept is inspired by the puzzle mechanics of *Is This Seat Taken?*, adapted into real-world scenarios like café, airport, and hospital queues.

Core Concept:-

- Players are given a set of characters
- Each character has a specific condition or preference
- The player must arrange them in a logical order
- Feedback is given through:
 - Character expressions (happy/angry)
 - Subtle cues instead of explicit correct/wrong

Iterations & Key Learnings:-

Total Testing Rounds: 4 (1 Paper Prototype + 3 Digital Iterations)

Key Learnings:

- Long descriptions increased cognitive load - simplified content
- Overlapping characters reduced clarity - improved spacing and layout
- Showing all options at once overwhelmed users - better visual hierarchy needed
- GDevelop had limitations for custom logic - shifted to HTML/CSS/JS
- Drag-and-drop interaction caused glitches - refined state handling
- Visual aesthetics needed improvement - enhanced UI and backgrounds
- Increasing number of characters caused visibility issues - improved layout responsiveness
- Adding subtle audio feedback improved engagement

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Key Features:-

- Drag-and-drop interaction
- Emotion-based feedback (no correct/wrong labels)
- Multiple scenarios (café, airport, hospital)
- Low-stimulation, no time pressure
- Progressive difficulty

Challenges:-

- Handling drag-and-drop bugs
- Managing increasing number of characters on screen
- Balancing simplicity with meaningful challenge

Final Outcome:-

A polished prototype with:

- Smooth interactions
- Clear visual hierarchy
- Reduced cognitive load
- Improved engagement through subtle feedback

TEAM-

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